1960 – 1975 • THE USA: CONFLICT AT HOME AND ABROAD

# THE USA, 1954–1975

*Key Topic 2: Protest, Progress and Radicalism (1960 – 1975)*



*Plate I: Over 250,000 Americans gather around the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool during the March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom (28 August 1963).*

**HISTORICAL OVERVIEW** 1960 – 1975

*"A new generation took to lunch counters, interstate buses, and city streets to accelerate the fight for equality. Confronting police dogs in Birmingham, tear gas on the Edmund Pettus Bridge in Selma, and bomb attacks across the South, direct action galvanized national conscience and compelled historic federal legislation."*

*"Yet legal victories could not heal the economic scars of Northern urban ghettos. Witness the shift toward Black Power, the rise of the Black Panther Party, and the tragic assassination of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. that fractured the nation's civil rights coalition."*

**KEY TOPIC 2 DIRECTORY** Christine Counsell Disciplinary Enquiry Programme • 4 Flat Double-Page Spreads — FOUR CANONICAL ENQUIRIES

**ENQUIRY 2.1** pp. 4–5 — Ref [1.1]–[1.4]

### Non-Violent Direct Action: Sit-Ins, Freedom Rides & James Meredith

PART I The Greensboro Lunch Counter Sit-Ins & The Birth of SNCC
PART II The Freedom Rides, Anniston Firebombing & Ole Miss Riots

KEY QUESTION
*How did student-led direct action provoke violent white backlash and force federal protection of interstate transit?*

**ENQUIRY 2.2** pp. 6–7 — Ref [2.1]–[2.4]

### Birmingham, The March on Washington & Landmark Legislation (1963–65)

PART I Project C in Birmingham, Children's Crusade & The 1963 March
PART II Bloody Sunday in Selma, LBJ's Leverage & The Voting Rights Act

KEY QUESTION
*How did peaceful campaigns in Birmingham and Selma directly compel the passage of the Civil Rights Act (1964) and Voting Rights Act (1965)?*

**ENQUIRY 2.3** pp. 8–9 — Ref [3.1]–[3.4]

### Black Power, Malcolm X & The Fragmentation of the Movement

PART I Malcolm X, The Nation of Islam & The Rejection of Non-Violence
PART II Stokely Carmichael, Black Power & The Black Panther Party

KEY QUESTION
*Why did the civil rights movement fracture in the mid-1960s into the radicalism of Black Power and armed self-defense?*

**ENQUIRY 2.4** pp. 10–11 — Ref [4.1]–[4.4]

### Urban Rebellions, The Kerner Report & The Assassination of MLK

PART I Urban Rioting in Watts and Detroit & The 1968 Kerner Report
PART II The Chicago Campaign, King's Assassination & Movement Legacy

KEY QUESTION
*Why did violent rebellions erupt across American cities between 1965 and 1968, and what were the consequences of MLK's assassination?*

# PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION DIRECTORY

**OFFICIAL SYLLABUS CONTENT • KEY TOPIC 2: PROTEST, PROGRESS AND RADICALISM**

**ISSUE 6 VERBATIM**

| PAPER CODE & TITLE | ASSESSMENT TARIFF | EXAM QUESTIONS |
|---|---|---|
| **1HI0/33 • Paper 3 Modern Depth Study** | **90 Mins • 52 Marks Total (incl. 4 SPaG) • 30% GCSE** | **Section A (Inference 4m, Causation 12m) • Section B (Utility 8m, Verdict 16m+4)** |

**SUBTOPIC 2.1** pp. 4–5 • Ref [1.1]–[1.4]

## Developments, 1960–62

- The significance of Greensboro and the sit-in movement.
- Reasons for, key features and significance of the Freedom Riders, including Ku Klux Klan violence and the Anniston bomb (1961).
- The James Meredith case (1962).

**SUBTOPIC 2.2** pp. 6–7 • Ref [2.1]–[2.4]

## Peaceful protests and their impact, 1963–65

- King and the peace marches of 1963 in Birmingham and Washington.
- Freedom Summer and the Mississippi murders.
- The impact of peaceful protest and the roles of Presidents Kennedy and Johnson in the passage of the Civil Rights Act (1964). Selma and the Voting Rights Act (1965).

**SUBTOPIC 2.3** pp. 8–9 • Ref [3.1]–[3.4]

## Malcolm X and Black Power, 1963–70

- Malcolm X, his beliefs, methods and involvement with the Black Muslims. His later change of attitude and assassination.
- Reasons for the emergence of Black Power. The significance of Stokely Carmichael and the 1968 Mexico Olympics.
- The methods and achievements of the Black Panther movement.

**SUBTOPIC 2.4** pp. 10–11 • Ref [4.1]–[4.4]

## The civil rights movement, 1965–75

- The riots of 1965–67 and the Kerner Report (1968).
- King's campaign in the North. The assassination of Martin Luther King and its impact.
- The extent of progress in civil rights by 1975.

### PEARSON EDEXCEL PAPER 3 EXAMINATION BLUEPRINT & QUESTION TARIFF

**52 MARKS TOTAL • 90 MINS • 30% OF GCSE HISTORY**

#### ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVES (TARIFF BREAKDOWN)

**AO1 (14m • 27%):** Recall, select and deploy accurate historical knowledge.
**AO2 (12m • 23%):** Explain and analyse causation, consequence and change.
**AO3 (8m • 15%):** Analyse and evaluate contemporary source utility in historical context.
**AO4 (16m • 31%):** Analyse, evaluate and judge differing historical interpretations.
**SPaG (4m • 4%):** Accurate spelling, punctuation, grammar and specialist vocabulary.

#### PAPER 3 QUESTION ARCHITECTURE (SECTION A & SECTION B)

**Section A Q1 (4m • AO3):** Source Inference • Two supported inferences from Source A.
**Section A Q2 (12m • AO1/AO2):** Causation • Explain why [event happened] (3 PEEL paras).
**Section B Q3(a) (8m • AO3):** Source Utility • How useful are Sources B & C (Content & COP).
**Section B Q3(b–c) (8m • AO4):** Interpretations • Main difference (4m) and reasons for difference (4m).
**Section B Q3(d) (16m+4 • AO4/AO1):** Interpretation Evaluation • How far do you agree?

# KEY TOPIC 2 MILESTONE SPINE

**TEN DEFINING CAUSAL TURNING POINTS • 1960 – 1975**

CHRONOLOGICAL HIGHWAY

**1 Feb 1960**

### Greensboro Lunch Counter Sit-Ins

Ref [2.1]

Four Black students refuse to leave segregated Woolworth's counter, sparking a movement across 50 cities and founding SNCC.

**4 May 1961**

### CORE Freedom Rides & Anniston Bus Bombing

Ref [2.1]

Interracial activists test transit desegregation; KK mob firebombs bus in Alabama, forcing federal protection.

**30 Sept 1962**

### James Meredith & Battle of Ole Miss

Ref [2.1]

Federal troops escort Meredith to enroll at University of Mississippi after Governor Barnett incites lethal riots.

**3 May 1963**

### Project C & The Children's Crusade in Birmingham

Ref [2.2]

Bull Connor turns high-pressure hoses and attack dogs on child marchers; televised brutality outrages nation.

**28 Aug 1963**

### The March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom

Ref [2.2]

250,000 demonstrators gather at Lincoln Memorial; King delivers iconic "I Have a Dream" address.

**21 June 1964**

### Freedom Summer Murders in Mississippi

Ref [2.2]

KKK murders civil rights workers Schwerner, Chaney, and Goodman during Black voter registration drive.

**2 July 1964**

### Civil Rights Act of 1964 Signed

Ref [2.2]

President Johnson signs landmark bill outlawing racial segregation in public accommodations, schools, and jobs.

**21 Feb 1965**

### Assassination of Malcolm X

Ref [2.3]

Former Nation of Islam leader assassinated in Harlem after adopting orthodox Sunni Islam and global solidarity.

**7 Mar 1965**

### "Bloody Sunday" on the Edmund Pettus Bridge

Ref [2.2]

State troopers brutally attack voting rights marchers in Selma, Alabama; Johnson introduces Voting Rights Act.

**6 Aug 1965**

### Voting Rights Act of 1965 Passed

Ref [2.2]

Federal law bans literacy tests and deploys federal registrars, transforming Southern Black political participation.

**Oct 1966**

### Founding of the Black Panther Party

Ref [2.3]

Huey Newton and Bobby Seale establish armed citizen patrols and community survival programs in Oakland.

**4 Apr 1968**

### Assassination of Martin Luther King Jr.

Ref [2.4]

King shot dead at Lorraine Motel in Memphis; nationwide rebellions erupt in over 100 cities, fragmenting movement.

KEY TOPIC 2 • ENQUIRY 1 OF 4

*Part I: The Greensboro Lunch Counter Sit-Ins & The Birth of SNCC*

# Non-Violent Direct Action: Sit-Ins, Freedom Rides & James Meredith

**KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION** *How did student-led direct action provoke violent white backlash and force federal protection of interstate transit?*

[1.1]

## The Greensboro Spark & the Student Nonviolent Movement

**The Greensboro Lunch Counter Sit-Ins:** On 1 February 1960, four Black freshmen from North Carolina A&T College—Ezell Blair Jr., Franklin McCain, Joseph McNeil, and David Richmond—walked into the Woolworth's department store in downtown Greensboro, purchased sundries, and sat at the whites-only lunch counter. Refused service, they remained politely seated until the store closed. The following morning, they returned with twenty additional students. Within five days, over 300 students occupied local counters. The tactic caught fire across the South: by August 1960, over 70,000 Black and white students had participated in sit-ins across dozens of cities, leading to more than 3,000 arrests but successfully integrating over 100 lunch counters.

**The Founding of the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC):** In April 1960, legendary SCLC activist Ella Baker organized a conference of young activists at Shaw University in Raleigh, North Carolina. Baker warned the students against being subsumed under the cautious, minister-dominated hierarchy of Dr Martin Luther King Jr.'s SCLC. The students formed the Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee (SNCC), committed to grassroots participatory democracy and aggressive non-violent civil disobedience. SNCC transformed the civil rights movement from occasional legal challenges into an unrelenting, youth-driven daily confrontation against Southern white supremacy.

[1.2]

## The Freedom Rides of 1961 & the Crisis of Interstate Transit

**Testing the Law: The CORE Freedom Rides:** Although the Supreme Court had outlawed segregation in interstate bus terminals in *Boynton v. Virginia* (1960), Southern bus companies and municipal police routinely ignored federal law. On 4 May 1961, James Farmer, director of the Congress of Racial Equality (CORE), launched the "Freedom Rides". Interracial groups boarded Greyhound and Trailways buses in Washington, D.C., bound for New Orleans, determined to deliberately test whether Southern authorities would enforce federal transit desegregation.

**Firebombs and Savage Violence in Alabama:** On Mother's Day, 14 May 1961, the Greyhound bus was intercepted outside Anniston, Alabama, by an armed Ku Klux Klan mob. White vigilantes slashed the tires, firebombed the vehicle, and held the doors shut to roast the riders alive; the activists barely escaped through smoke and shattered windows, only to be brutally beaten with iron pipes. An hour later, riders on the Trailways bus arrived at Birmingham, where Public Safety Commissioner Eugene "Bull" Connor gave Klan thugs fifteen unhindered minutes to beat the riders unconscious. Graphic press photographs of the smouldering wreckage shocked the international community.

**ENQUIRY 2.1 PART II: CLIMAX, TURNING POINTS & CONSEQUENCES** *Part II: The Freedom Rides, Anniston Firebombing & Ole Miss Riots*

**DECISIVE HISTORICAL MECHANISM** *Non-violent activists deliberately provoked violent white extremist overreactions in full view of national media, compelling reluctant federal officials to intervene and enforce desegregation decrees.*

[1.3]

### Federal Intervention and the Battle of "Ole Miss"

**Robert Kennedy and the Interstate Commerce Commission:** The savagery in Alabama created an acute foreign policy dilemma for President John F. Kennedy, who was preparing for a high-stakes summit in Vienna with Soviet Premier Nikita Khrushchev. Attorney General Robert F. Kennedy deployed 400 federal marshals to protect riders in Montgomery and petitioned the Interstate Commerce Commission (ICC). On 1 November 1961, the ICC issued strict regulations mandating the removal of all racial signs in bus terminals and stations, representing a clear operational victory for non-violent direct action.

**The Insurrection at the University of Mississippi (1962):** Direct action soon expanded to Southern university campuses. In September 1962, James Meredith, an Air Force veteran, attempted to enrol as the first Black student at the University of Mississippi ("Ole Miss"), backed by a federal court order. Mississippi Governor Ross Barnett personally blocked Meredith at the registrar's office. When 500 federal marshals escorted Meredith onto campus on 30 September, a furious white mob of 2,500 attacked them with firearms, petrol bombs, and acid. Two civilians were killed and 300 marshals injured before President Kennedy federalized the state guard and sent 31,000 soldiers to restore order. Meredith enrolled the following morning under military guard.

[1.4]

### The Historical Verdict: Tactical Coercion of Federal Authority

**Exposing Federal Reluctance Through Direct Confrontation:** The campaigns of 1960–62 demonstrated that moral persuasion alone could never dismantle Southern segregation. Both the Eisenhower and early Kennedy administrations had sought to avoid antagonizing powerful Southern segregationist committee chairmen in Congress. By creating public crises that Southern police met with barbaric violence, student activists deliberately forced federal executive intervention, transforming civil rights from a state issue into an inescapable federal constitutional duty.

**A Hardened Generation of Grassroots Leaders:** These early direct-action campaigns forged a new cohort of battle-tested leaders, including John Lewis, Diane Nash, and James Farmer. While legal victories established theoretical rights, it was the courage of ordinary students sitting at lunch counters and boarding firebombed buses that made those rights real. By the close of 1962, the civil rights movement had established the tactical template that would shatter Southern Jim Crow forever in the climactic battles of Birmingham and Selma.

KEY TOPIC 2 • ENQUIRY 2 OF 4

*Part I: Project C in Birmingham, Children's Crusade & The 1963 March*

# Birmingham, The March on Washington & Landmark Legislation (1963–65)

**KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION** *How did peaceful campaigns in Birmingham and Selma directly compel the passage of the Civil Rights Act (1964) and Voting Rights Act (1965)?*

[2.1]

## Project C in Birmingham: Confronting Bull Connor's Terror

**Targeting the Citadel of Southern Segregation:** In April 1963, Dr Martin Luther King Jr., the SCLC, and local leader Rev. Fred Shuttlesworth launched "Project C" (for Confrontation) in Birmingham, Alabama—widely regarded as the most segregated city in America. Recognizing that municipal desegregation required severe economic pressure, activists targeted downtown department stores with sit-ins and boycotts. Birmingham's notorious Commissioner of Public Safety, Eugene "Bull" Connor, responded with mass arrests, imprisoning King on Good Friday. While incarcerated, King wrote his famous *Letter from Birmingham Jail*, declaring that "justice too long delayed is justice denied."

**The Children's Crusade and Televised Brutality:** Facing dwindling adult volunteers fearful of losing their jobs, SCLC organizer James Bevel recruited thousands of school students. On 2 and 3 May 1963, over a thousand young marchers poured out of the 16th Street Baptist Church. Connor unleashed snarling police dogs and commanded firefighters to blast the children with high-pressure fire hoses that tore clothes and rolled youths down the asphalt. Televised images of children being mauled by police dogs horrified the nation and forced white business leaders to agree to a desegregation pact on 10 May.

[2.2]

## The March on Washington & the Battle for the Civil Rights Act

**The Historic March on Washington for Jobs and Freedom:** Emboldened by Birmingham, civil rights leaders organized the March on Washington on 28 August 1963. Over 250,000 Americans—nearly a quarter of them white—gathered peacefully at the Lincoln Memorial. The event climaxed with Dr King's iconic "I Have a Dream" address, which framed the freedom struggle within the grand promise of the American Declaration of Independence. The march demonstrated unprecedented interracial unity and exerted immense moral pressure on the Kennedy administration to enact comprehensive federal legislation.

**Lyndon B. Johnson and the Civil Rights Act of 1964:** Following Kennedy's assassination in November 1963, President Lyndon B. Johnson threw his immense legislative mastery behind the stalled civil rights bill. Defying Southern Democrats who staged a grueling 54-day Senate filibuster, Johnson signed the landmark Civil Rights Act on 2 July 1964. The Act delivered the death blow to Jim Crow: it outlawed racial discrimination in public accommodations, prohibited employment discrimination via the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC), and empowered the Justice Department to sue non-compliant school boards.

**ENQUIRY 2.2 PART II: CLIMAX, TURNING POINTS & CONSEQUENCES**

*Part II: Bloody Sunday in Selma, LBJ's Leverage & The Voting Rights Act*

**DECISIVE HISTORICAL MECHANISM** *Televised police brutality against peaceful marchers created unbearable moral pressure on Washington, allowing President Johnson to overcome Southern filibusters and dismantle legal segregation.*

[2.3]

### Bloody Sunday at Selma & the Voting Rights Revolution

**The Struggle for the Southern Ballot:** Despite the 1964 Act, Southern Black citizens remained systematically disenfranchised. In early 1965, the SCLC joined SNCC in Selma, Alabama, where fewer than 2% of eligible Black adults were registered to vote. On Sunday, 7 March 1965 ("Bloody Sunday"), 600 peaceful marchers led by John Lewis attempted to march fifty miles to Montgomery. As they crossed the Edmund Pettus Bridge, Alabama state troopers on horseback, armed with tear gas and billy clubs, charged into the unarmed crowd, fracturing Lewis's skull and brutally beating marchers.

**The Voting Rights Act of 1965:** Television networks interrupted regular broadcasting to air footage of state-sanctioned savagery, triggering nationwide outrage. On 15 March, President Johnson addressed a joint session of Congress, calling Selma "a turning point in man's unending search for freedom" and concluding with the civil rights anthem: "And we shall overcome." On 6 August 1965, Johnson signed the Voting Rights Act. The law suspended all literacy tests and dispatched federal registrars to Southern counties. Within three years, Black voter registration in Mississippi skyrocketed from 7% to over 60%, revolutionizing Southern electoral politics.

[2.4]

### The Historical Verdict: The Legislative Destruction of Jim Crow

**The High-Water Mark of the Non-Violent Coalition:** Between May 1963 and August 1965, the mainstream civil rights coalition achieved its greatest constitutional and legislative triumphs. The combination of local sacrificial bravery, brilliant tactical provocation of violent white authorities, moral television imagery, and presidential political will dismantled the entire statutory architecture of Southern apartheid that had stood since Reconstruction.

**The Looming Frontier of Economic Disparity:** Yet even as President Johnson signed the Voting Rights Act, the seeds of future division were evident. Just five days later, the Watts ghetto in Los Angeles erupted in flames. Federal legislation had dismantled legal segregation in the South, but it had done almost nothing to solve the crushing problems of ghetto housing, police brutality, and entrenched economic poverty in the urban North and West. The movement's triumphant legislative era was over; an era of radical rebellion was about to begin.

KEY TOPIC 2 • ENQUIRY 3 OF 4

*Part I: Malcolm X, The Nation of Islam & The Rejection of Non-Violence*

# Black Power, Malcolm X & The Fragmentation of the Movement

**KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION** *Why did the civil rights movement fracture in the mid-1960s into the radicalism of Black Power and armed self-defense?*

[3.1]

## Malcolm X & the Challenge to Southern Non-Violence

**The Voice of the Northern Ghetto:** While Dr King preached Christian love and legal integration in the rural South, millions of Black Americans in the squalid tenements of Harlem, Chicago, and Detroit experienced a very different reality. Their struggle was not against Jim Crow signs, but against *de facto* segregation, slum housing, joblessness, and white police violence. The fiery spokesman for this disillusioned urban populace was Malcolm X (born Malcolm Little), chief minister of the Nation of Islam (NOI), a religious movement led by the Honourable Elijah Muhammad.

**"By Any Means Necessary":** Malcolm X rejected King's integrationist philosophy, dismissing non-violence as a slave mentality that left Black people defenseless against white terrorism. Advocating Black nationalism, economic self-reliance, and armed self-defence, he urged African Americans to demand justice "by any means necessary." After breaking with the Nation of Islam in March 1964 and undertaking the pilgrimage to Mecca, Malcolm softened his racial separatism, embracing orthodox Islam and founding the Organization of Afro-American Unity. On 21 February 1965, he was assassinated in Manhattan by NOI gunmen, leaving a profound intellectual legacy for the rising generation.

[3.2]

## The Meredith March & the Cry of "Black Power"

**The Meredith March and the Ideological Fracture:** In June 1966, James Meredith began a solo "March Against Fear" across Mississippi to encourage Black voter registration, only to be ambushed and wounded by a white gunman on the second day. Leaders of the major civil rights organizations—Dr King for the SCLC, Floyd McKissick for CORE, and newly elected chairman Stokely Carmichael for SNCC—rushed to Mississippi to continue the march. Tensions between the groups soon erupted into the open.

**Carmichael and the Birth of a Slogan:** Carmichael and younger SNCC field workers were deeply exhausted by white supremacist beatings, federal inaction, and the deaths of colleagues during the 1964 Freedom Summer. At a mass rally in Greenwood, Mississippi, after being arrested for the 27th time, Carmichael leaped onto the platform and shouted to the crowd: "We want Black Power!" The crowd roared back in thunderous unison. Black Power rejected white liberal financial backing, expelled white members from SNCC, and declared that Black Americans would build their own political and economic institutions rather than beg for admission into white society.

**ENQUIRY 2.3 PART II: CLIMAX, TURNING POINTS & CONSEQUENCES** *Part II: Stokely Carmichael, Black Power & The Black Panther Party*

**DECISIVE HISTORICAL MECHANISM** *Persistent Northern ghetto poverty and police brutality unmasked the limits of non-violence, leading disillusioned youth to embrace Malcolm X's nationalism and community self-defense.*

[3.3]

### The Black Panther Party: Armed Self-Defence & Survival Programs

**Founding the Black Panther Party for Self-Defense:** In October 1966, Huey P. Newton and Bobby Seale founded the Black Panther Party in Oakland, California. Wearing distinctive black leather jackets and berets, the Panthers armed themselves with shotguns and law books, conducting armed patrols of Black neighbourhoods to monitor and deter police brutality. In May 1967, the Panthers marched fully armed into the California State Capitol in Sacramento to protest a gun control bill designed to disarm them, catapulting the party into international notoriety.

**Survival Programs and State Repression:** While demonized by the white media as violent revolutionaries, the Panthers operated extensive community "survival programs". They provided free hot breakfasts to over 20,000 poor schoolchildren daily, established free medical clinics, and operated sickle-cell anemia screening centers. However, their Marxist-Leninist rhetoric and armed posturing provoked ruthless federal retaliation. FBI Director J. Edgar Hoover branded the Panthers the "greatest internal security threat" in America, deploying the counter-intelligence program (COINTELPRO) to infiltrate, discredit, and violently assassinate Panther leaders, including Fred Hampton in Chicago in 1969.

[3.4]

### The Historical Verdict: Ideological Bifurcation and Cultural Pride

**A Movement Irrevocably Split:** By the late 1960s, the civil rights movement had split into two rival ideological camps. Dr King and the older generation maintained their commitment to Christian non-violence and interracial coalitions, while younger radicals embraced Black Power, armed self-defence, and anti-imperialist solidarity with Third World liberation movements. This militant shift alienated white liberal allies and contributed to a conservative political backlash among white voters that propelled Richard Nixon to the White House in 1968.

**The Permanent Transformation of Black Identity:** Nevertheless, Black Power achieved a profound psychological and cultural revolution. Slogans like "Black is Beautiful," the adoption of natural Afro hairstyles, and the emergence of Black Studies departments in universities liberated millions of African Americans from centuries of internalized inferiority. The dramatic protest by sprinters Tommie Smith and John Carlos on the medal podium at the 1968 Mexico City Olympics permanently symbolized this unyielding demand for global dignity and human rights.

KEY TOPIC 2 • ENQUIRY 4 OF 4

*Part I: Urban Rioting in Watts and Detroit & The 1968 Kerner Report*

# Urban Rebellions, The Kerner Report & The Assassination of MLK

**KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION** *Why did violent rebellions erupt across American cities between 1965 and 1968, and what were the consequences of MLK's assassination?*

[4.1]

## The Long Hot Summers: Watts, Newark & Detroit in Flames

**The Explosion of the Northern Ghettos:** Between 1964 and 1968, more than 300 major urban uprisings erupted in over 200 American cities. The first catastrophic explosion occurred in August 1965 in the Watts ghetto of Los Angeles, triggered by the violent arrest of a young Black motorist by the California Highway Patrol. Six days of rioting left 34 people dead, over 1,000 injured, and 4,000 arrested, with $40 million in property damage. Watts proved that federal civil rights laws passed in Washington meant nothing to impoverished urban youths trapped in deteriorating ghettos.

**The Cataclysm of 1967: Newark and Detroit:** The urban crisis reached its terrifying zenith during the "Long Hot Summer" of 1967. In Newark, New Jersey, twenty-six people died following days of street battles. Two weeks later, Detroit exploded in the bloodiest civil disorder in modern US history. Sparked by a police raid on a blind pig (after-hours drinking club), five days of rebellion resulted in 43 deaths, 7,000 arrests, and the destruction of over 2,000 buildings. President Johnson was forced to deploy thousands of armed federal paratroopers of the 82nd and 101st Airborne Divisions, backed by tanks and armoured personnel carriers, to retake American city streets.

[4.2]

## King Turns North: The SCLC and the Chicago Campaign

**Confronting Northern De Facto Segregation:** Shaken by the urban conflagrations, Dr Martin Luther King Jr. resolved to take the non-violent crusade into Northern cities. In January 1966, King launched the Chicago Freedom Movement, moving his family into a dilapidated, unheated third-floor tenement in the West Side slum of North Lawndale. King sought to challenge systemic economic apartheid: discriminatory bank mortgage redlining, extortionate slum slumlords, and racially segregated schools orchestrated by powerful Democratic Mayor Richard J. Daley.

**The Hate of Marquette Park:** The Northern campaign proved far more grueling and hostile than the South. When King led peaceful marchers through all-white neighbourhoods such as Marquette Park to demand open housing, they were attacked by thousands of venomous white residents hurling bricks, bottles, and firecrackers, waving swastikas and Confederate battle flags. Struck in the head by a rock, King grimly remarked: "I have seen many mobs in Mississippi and Alabama, but I have never seen in Alabama or Mississippi mobs as hostile and as hate-filled as I've seen in Chicago." The campaign achieved only vague, non-enforceable promises from municipal officials, demonstrating the stubborn resistance of Northern white homeowners.

**ENQUIRY 2.4 PART II: CLIMAX, TURNING POINTS & CONSEQUENCES**

*Part II: The Chicago Campaign, King's Assassination & Movement Legacy*

**DECISIVE HISTORICAL MECHANISM** *Structural racism, systemic job discrimination, and residential segregation sparked explosive urban riots; the assassination of Martin Luther King Jr. ended the heroic era of non-violent coalition politics.*

[4.3]

### The Kerner Report and the Martyrdom of Dr King

**The Kerner Commission's Scathing Indictment:** To investigate the root causes of the urban revolts, President Johnson appointed the National Advisory Commission on Civil Disorders, chaired by Illinois Governor Otto Kerner. Released in February 1968, the Kerner Report shocked white America by refuting conservative claims that riots were planned by communist agitators. The report identified the true culprit: systemic white racism. It famously warned: "Our nation is moving toward two societies, one black, one white—separate and unequal." The report demanded billions in federal funding for urban jobs, housing, and schools, but Johnson, overwhelmed by Vietnam War spending, shelved its recommendations.

**The Assassination of Dr King (4 April 1968):** In the spring of 1968, King traveled to Memphis, Tennessee, to support striking Black sanitation workers and organize a national Poor People's Campaign. On the evening of 4 April 1968, while standing on the balcony of the Lorraine Motel, King was assassinated by white supremacist James Earl Ray. King's murder unleashed the largest nationwide wave of social unrest in American history: uprisings erupted in over 125 cities, leaving 46 dead and requiring 45,000 troops to quell. In Washington, D.C., fires burned within sight of the White House. A week later, Congress rushed to pass the Civil Rights Act of 1968 (the Fair Housing Act), banning housing discrimination.

[4.4]

### The Historical Verdict: Progress, Division, and Legacy by 1975

**A Transformed Political Landscape:** By 1975, the civil rights movement had fundamentally transformed the American South. The blatant barbarism of de jure segregation was extinct, and millions of enfranchised Black citizens wielded decisive political power, electing thousands of Black municipal officials, sheriffs, and members of Congress. In major cities, Black mayors took office in Cleveland, Gary, Newark, Detroit, Los Angeles, and Atlanta. Affirmative action programs opened the doors of universities, corporations, and federal civil service to a growing Black middle class.

**The Unfinished Revolution of Economic Justice:** Yet the promise of full racial equality remained tragically unfulfilled. As legal barriers fell, white Americans retreated into suburban enclaves ("white flight"), leaving inner-city schools and neighbourhoods more economically segregated than before. Dr King's ultimate crusade—the eradication of systemic poverty, urban ghettoization, and militarism—remained unfinished. The heroic era of 1954–75 had destroyed the legal pillars of racial apartheid, but it left the deeper structural inequalities of American capitalism and society unresolved.

# MASTER KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL QUIZ

**40 ESSENTIAL RECALL QUESTIONS • KEY TOPIC 2: PROTEST, PROGRESS AND RADICALISM** PARTNER QUIZ OR SOLO PRACTICE

**CLASSROOM PROTOCOL** **Oral Retrieval:** Work with a revision partner to test each card aloud without consulting the reading text. • **Written Synthesis:** Complete questions 1 to 40 in your revision book, referencing the paragraph anchors above each card to verify your answers.

## ENQUIRY 2.1 Non-Violent Direct Action: Sit-Ins, Freedom Rides & James Meredith

pp. 4–5 • Ref [1.1]–[1.4]

1. In which city did the famous 1960 lunch counter sit-ins begin?
2. What does the abbreviation SNCC stand for?
3. Which tactic was used by activists in 1961 to test the desegregation of interstate bus terminals?
4. What was the primary goal of the Freedom Riders in 1961?
5. Which civil rights organization organized the first Freedom Rides in 1961?
6. Who was the first Black student to register and enroll at the University of Mississippi in 1962?
7. Who was the president of the United States during the Freedom Rides and the James Meredith crisis?
8. Who was the Attorney General who sent federal marshals to protect James Meredith in Mississippi?
9. In which Alabama city was a Freedom Riders bus firebombed by a white mob in May 1961?
10. Which Georgia city was the target of SNCC's first major, though unsuccessful, desegregation campaign in 1961-62?

## ENQUIRY 2.2 Birmingham, The March on Washington & Landmark Legislation (1963–65)

pp. 6–7 • Ref [2.1]–[2.4]

11. Which Alabama city was the site of the 1963 civil rights campaign where police used dogs and fire hoses against children?
12. Who was the segregationist Police Commissioner of Birmingham who ordered the brutal response to protesters?
13. What was the name of the famous document written by Martin Luther King Jr. while imprisoned in Alabama in 1963?
14. What was the main purpose of the March on Washington in 1963?
15. What was the title of Martin Luther King Jr.'s famous speech delivered at the March on Washington?
16. Which US president originally proposed the Civil Rights Bill in June 1963 before his assassination?
17. Which US president signed the historic Civil Rights Act of 1964 into law?
18. Which Alabama city was the starting point for the 1965 marches where protesters were beaten on 'Bloody Sunday'?
19. What landmark voting law was passed in 1965 in response to the Selma campaign?
20. How many demonstrators participated in the March on Washington in August 1963?

## ENQUIRY 2.3 Black Power, Malcolm X & The Fragmentation of the Movement

pp. 8–9 • Ref [3.1]–[3.4]

21. Who was the leading spokesperson for the Nation of Islam (commonly known as the Black Muslims) who advocated self-defense in the early 1960s?
22. Which radical civil rights slogan was popularized by Stokely Carmichael during a 1966 march in Mississippi?
23. Who were the two co-founders of the Black Panther Party for Self-Defense, created in Oakland in 1966?
24. Which leader of the Nation of Islam (the Black Muslims) did Malcolm X clash with before breaking away in 1964?
25. How did Malcolm X's views on civil rights change after his pilgrimage to Mecca in 1964?
26. What was the main purpose of the Black Panther Party's Ten-Point Program?
27. Which two US athletes raised black-gloved fists during the medal ceremony at the 1968 Olympics?
28. In which California city was the Black Panther Party originally founded?
29. Which student organization officially rejected non-violence and adopted Black Power under Stokely Carmichael in 1966?
30. What secular activist organization did Malcolm X found after leaving the Nation of Islam in 1964?

## ENQUIRY 2.4 Urban Rebellions, The Kerner Report & The Assassination of MLK

pp. 10–11 • Ref [4.1]–[4.4]

31. Which district of Los Angeles was the site of massive, destructive race riots in August 1965?
32. What was the name of the federal commission appointed by Johnson that blamed white racism for the 1960s riots?
33. What was a major consequence of the assassination of Martin Luther King Jr. in 1968?
34. In which Southern city was Martin Luther King Jr. assassinated in 1968?
35. What was the name of the 1966 campaign where MLK moved into a slum to highlight poor housing in the North?
36. Who was convicted of the assassination of Martin Luther King Jr.?
37. Which federal law passed in April 1968 banned racial discrimination in the sale or rental of housing?
38. What SCLC campaign launched in 1968 aimed to bring thousands of poor Americans to camp out in Washington?
39. Who took over the leadership of the SCLC immediately after Martin Luther King Jr.'s assassination?
40. In how many US cities did major race riots break out in the week following Martin Luther King Jr.'s assassination?